

Week 3 Lab Template

From User Insight to Design Opportunity

Use this file during Week 3 lab to complete each stage of the synthesis process.
Tasks: Target User → Empathy Map → Persona → Journey Map → POV → How Might We
Duplicate slides if your team needs extra working space.

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How to Use This Template

Fill one section at a time as AIFFL unlocks each task.

Task 1: Choose one target user and clarify why this user matters.

Task 2: Complete the empathy map: says, thinks, does, feels, pain points, needs.

Task 3: Turn the empathy map into one evidence-based persona.

Task 4: Map one user journey with stages, feelings, pain points, and opportunities.

Task 5 & 6: Write one POV statement and 2–3 How Might We questions.

Task 1 · Choose One Target User

Complete this after AIFFL unlocks the USER stage.

Who is the target user?

CADT students from year 1 to year 4

Why does this user matter?

They face challenges in balancing academics and social life, which impacts their well-being and performance.

Main goal of this user

To manage academic and social life while maintaining good mental health.

Context of use

(Where, when, with what device, under what constraints?)

CADT students typically need support in a university setting, often with smartphones, laptops, or other devices in both on-campus and remote learning environments. Constraints include limited time due to academic schedules and the pressure of maintaining social connections.

Task 2 · Empathy Map

Complete for the chosen target user.

SAYS

- "I want to go out but I don't have time for that"
- "I wish I have more time in a day"
- "I want to do well but also have time for hang out"

THINKS

- How can I balance study and social life?
- Am I keeping up with everything?
- I should be more productive.
- I don't want to miss out with friend.

DOES

- Attends classes and take notes
- Studies and completes assignment
- Plans and meet friends
- Use phone to schedule and chat
- Adjusts plans when thing change

FEELS

- Stressed and overwhelmed
- Tired and have little time
- Guilty and when falling behind
- Anxious when deadline
- Happy when balance

PAIN POINTS

- Too many tasks
- Forget homework or deadline
- Plan change suddenly
- Not enough time

NEEDS

- Clear schedule and reminder
- Help prioritizing tasks
- Focus and time management tools
- Balance between study and free time

Task 3 · Persona

Turn the empathy map into one evidence-based persona.

Sreynith, second- year SE student at CADT

Short description

Sreynith is a second-year student who needs a simple way to manage study and social schedules due to many tasks, distractions, forgotten deadlines, and sudden changes.

Main goal

Balance study work and social life without falling behind in school.

Key frustration

Forgets tasks, gets distracted, and struggles to adjust plans when things change.

Context

Busy university life with assignments, group work, social events, and changing deadlines.

Quote

“Every week feels packed, and it’s hard to keep everything under control.”

Goals

- Keep up with all classes, assignments, and deadlines
- Have enough time for friends and fun activities
- Avoid stress and last-minute rushes
- Stick to plans and adjust easily when needed

Needs

- Simple, clear way to see all tasks and plans in one place
- Help to split time fairly between study and social life
- Quick way to update schedules when things shift
- Reminders so nothing forgotten

Behaviors

- Writes or types plans in notes or basic apps
- Tries to fit study time around social events
- Checks schedule often but still forgets things
- Gets distracted easily by phone or friends

Frustrations

- Too many tasks to track at once
- Plans change suddenly and mess everything up
- Gets distracted easily
- Hard to know how much time to spend on each thing

Task 4 · User Journey Map

Map one important experience for your persona.

Stage	What the user does	Thoughts / feelings	Pain point	Opportunity
Planning	Lists all classes, assignments, deadlines, and social plans	"There's so much to note down; I'm scared I'll miss something important."	Information overload; hard to organize all tasks clearly.	One place for academic and social plans.
Allocating	Assigns time slots for studying each subject and social activities	"I'm not sure if I've given enough time for each subject and activities."	Difficulty estimating time needed.	Smart time suggestions based on task priority.
Following	Follows the schedule, attends classes, studies, and joins activities	"I keep getting distracted by my phone or friends asking me out."	Easily distracted and hard to stay consistent.	Focus mode with reminders.
Adjusting	Tries to rearrange plans when deadlines shift or new events come up	"Changing everything takes so long, and now I'm confused."	Complex updates made me lose track of priorities.	One-click rescheduling with automatic priority updates.
Reflecting	Looks back at the week, checks what was done, and notes what went wrong	"I still feel like I didn't balance things well."	No clear feedback on how time was spent.	Weekly reports with insights and balance tips.

Task 5 & 6 · POV + How Might We

Turn synthesis into a focused opportunity statement.

POV Statement

University students need a simple way to manage study and social schedules because they struggle with too many tasks, distractions, forgotten deadlines, and sudden changes.

How Might We questions

How might we combine study and social plans in one place?

How might we help students allocate time easily?

How might we make updating schedules simple?